

On Air: RJ, Anyone?

Setting up your own radio station doesn't require a closet full of complex electronics and thick cabling—just a desktop computer and plugins. You will need to get hold of Shoutcast's Server and the Shoutcast Source DSP plugin. You will also need any 2.x version of Winamp and a good taste in music.

STEP 1 First, install the Shoutcast Server and choose the GUI version during install. Then, install the Shoutcast Source DSP plugin. After installation, start the server

from **Start > Programs > Shoutcast DNAS**. The server starts with the GUI monitor. If you want to tweak and play around

The Shoutcast server monitor

with the default settings, click on Edit config to access the config file. Follow the instructions here and you can't go wrong.

STEP 2 Start Winamp and load in your favourite songs. Then start the Shoutcast Source DSP plugin from **Options > Preferences** and select DSP/Effect Plugin.



Select the Nullsoft Source DSP plugin from the list

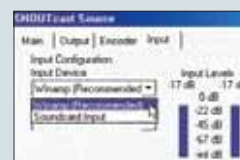
Choose the Nullsoft Shoutcast Source DSP plugin from the list. This opens up the Shoutcast Source DSP settings menu. The Main tab shows you the status of the five output streams listed. If you are not connected, you will see 'Not Connected' under status.

STEP 3 You also have three more tabs.

Click on Encoder and set the MP3 encoding quality settings. Here the default settings are fine—tweak them only if you are certain that you have enough bandwidth. Under



Set encoding quality here

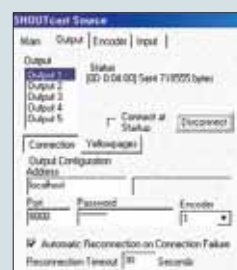


Select the input source here

choose soundcard input. This would require a microphone or external signal to be connected to your soundcard. So drop that in and add a dash of RJing!

STEP 4 Now click on Output to check out the output

settings. The default connection settings are fine; if you have changed anything in the Server config file, this is the time to update that entry here. Finally, for that additional pizzazz, click on Yellowpages to configure the essentials, including the name and listing details.



Output sets your connection settings

At Windows Media's Radio Centre (<http://www.windowsmedia.com/mg/Radio.asp?>), check out the vast range of stations spread across genres that broadcast in the WMA format. Find great Indian music at Radio Of India (www.radioofindia.com), or check out Sur Sangeet Radio (www.sur-sangeet.com). Yahoo! Launchcast serves out good content at <http://launch.yahoo.com/launchcast/>, while Radioio (www.radioio.com) lets you access music from a lot of popular bands from different periods.

If you are looking for independent artists, try the stations at Shoutcast. For other niche music, you can try any of the above sites and search within the particular genre—for example, if Beethoven is what you want, then one of the most popular radio stations online would be Beethoven.com (www.beethoven.com), which is listed across most of the station guides. Incidentally, many terrestrial stations broadcast on the Web too. These radio stations bring on their full range of radio entertainment and programming online and can be tuned in to from their home page or RadioTower.

And there's more

There is more to Web radio than just music—the entire range of radio programming that you can access from the airwaves can be plucked off the Web waves. There are stations where you can get the latest news and listen to debates on current events that matter. BBC (www.bbc.co.uk/radio/) and CNN (www.cnn.com/audio) have their entire



Bookmarking your favourites, with Winamp

range of radio programmes online. You can tune into their news, current affairs and lifestyle programs and also catch up on sport commentaries. If technology news is your thing, CNET's News.com (www.cnet.com/broadband/0-7227152.html) features a wide range of radio programmes that deals with personal technology, tech news, as well as talk shows on the emerging technologies of the day. WebRadios (www.webradios.com) has an assortment of channels, most of which are located in North America, broadcasting local news. Their music section is quite comprehensive—you get to choose from a smaller list of genres, but there are many stations listed for each. For up-to-the-minute news and talk shows throughout the day, log on to the New York Times online (www.nytimes.com) and tune into their Web radio station. In fact, you will find more online than is possible with offline radio.

Even offbeat content is easily accessed, thanks to the unconventional-ity of the Internet. If you missed the radio plays of the early 20th century, or